

8 March 1978

CHINA CHANGES COURSE

In the vacuum following Mao Zedong's death, the moderate Deng Xiaoping emerged as China's leader. He used his position to introduce limited free-market reforms and greater personal freedoms. The changes spurred rapid economic growth. This marked the beginning of China's "Reform and Opening Up".

▷ Mural showing China's "Four Modernizations"



1976

9 September 1976 Mao Zedong dies; his wife and other powerful officials (the Gang of Four) are arrested

13 July 1977 Somali forces invade Ethiopia, starting the Ogaden War

17 September 1978
CAMP DAVID ACCORDS

In the wake of the Yom Kippur War, US President Jimmy Carter sought to revive the Middle East peace process. He eventually succeeded in bringing Israel's premier Menachem Begin and Egypt's Anwar Sadat together at Camp David in Maryland. The men signed a framework agreement that led six months later to a peace treaty between the two nations.



△ Sadat and Begin embrace as Carter applauds

1976-2007
THE COMPUTER REVOLUTION



Once the preserve of large companies, institutions, and universities, computers became available to consumers in the 1970s.

1976 Steve Jobs and Steve Wozniak found the Apple Computer Company introducing the Apple 1, with its single circuit board.

1981 IBM unveils the Acorn, the first Personal Computer (PC) to use the MS-DOS operating system developed by Microsoft.

1990 Tim Berners-Lee develops HyperText Mark-up Language (HTML), paving the way for the World Wide Web.

2007 The introduction of the iPhone and other smartphones places computing power into consumer's pockets.